

CSS 1302

Informative Speech Planning Worksheet Complete Document & Upload to Canvas

Informative Speech Overview:

Develop and deliver an intellectually stimulating speech that teaches about a(n) *profession-oriented* concept to a group of non-experts (object, process, event, or concept). Consider your field of study, future career, and current courses to identify a topic (e.g., how to begin investing, selecting the right camera for your business, what happens to your body when you go under anesthesia, etc.).

Goals:

The purposes of this speech are

1. to educate the audience about an interesting and relevant topic related to the professions
2. to construct and deliver messages in a clear and organized manner
3. to support claims with visual information and credible evidence
4. to speak extemporaneously

Answer the following questions as you continue to develop your Informative Speech. You will turn this in at the end of the week. As you plan for your Informative Speech, you should work on components of your speech in the order presented here (topic + purpose, then audience analysis, then begin constructing your content starting with the Body before the Introduction and Conclusion).

Topic & Purpose.

What is the topic of your speech? Why is it appropriate for you?

The topic of my speech will be focused on the escalating prevalence of neurodegenerative diseases as well as a solution for it. This topic is particularly relevant to me because I've learned a great deal about it in my classes, and because it directly relates to my major/specialty (neuroscience). Additionally, I find the topic to be quite interesting, given its current relevance and its devastating effects.

Why is the topic appropriate for your audience?

This topic is appropriate for my audience of 18–22-year-old college students because, while they may feel young and healthy now, the rise of neurodegenerative diseases will significantly impact their future as both professionals and family members. As many of my classmates are finishing their core curriculum and entering their specific fields of study, they need to understand how cognitive health intersects with their future careers and societal stability.

Which type of informative speech are you presenting (object, process, event, or concept)? Explain.

I'll be giving an informative speech of the "concept" type, since I will be discussing both the overall concept of what neurodegenerative diseases are AND concepts on how to prevent them from occurring.

How is your topic narrowed to conform to the time limits for this assignment?

Instead of covering the entire field of neurology, I am narrowing my focus to three specific pillars: the basic biological mechanism of these diseases, the specific reasons for their modern rise (such as environmental factors or AI usage), and actionable preventative measures. By focusing only on these three areas, I can provide depth without exceeding the time limit.

Write your specific purpose statement.

To inform my audience about three concepts on neurodegenerative diseases: what they are, why their prevalence is on the rise, and how to prevent them.

What is your thesis? Remember that the thesis should state your three main points (Come back to this question after you complete the “Body” section later in this document).

As neurodegenerative diseases become an increasing global health concern, it is vital to understand the biological nature of these conditions, the modern lifestyle and environmental factors driving their rising prevalence, and the proactive preventative measures we can take to safeguard our cognitive health.

Audience Analysis.

Who is your audience?

My audience consists of fellow classmates from my online Baylor “Speech” course (CSS 1302 W1). These fellow students are roughly 18-22 years old with collegiate-level education, all of whom have finished (or nearly finished) their “core curriculum” courses. Lastly, the audience consists of a variety of undergraduate majors, so I need to be careful with technical terms.

How much do you think your audience already knows about your topic?

I would assume that my audience has little foreknowledge of my topic. However, they probably have a grasp on dementia’s prevalence since the average person knows at least one person (if not multiple) facing this health disorder. Also, my audience is likely to have a general understanding of the symptoms and effects associated with neurodegenerative diseases.

How interested do you think college students are in learning more about your topic?

My topic may not particularly enthrall the average college student; however, I believe it is interesting enough to keep them engaged. This is especially true once I explain to them the prevalence of these diseases and the severity of their impact (therefore making the issue directly relevant to them).

What information do you plan to share that is new and interesting to your audience?

My audience is unlikely to understand the workings of this disease, which I will explain in my first main point. For my second main point, I’ll present information on solutions to this issue, one of which will be for one to remain conscious of their AI usage as it affects brain health. Lastly, I doubt that my audience

truly/fully appreciate the rising prevalence of these diseases and the amount of investments being thrown at research into neurodegenerative diseases.

In what ways is this topic relevant to your audience?

The topic of my speech will be relevant to my audience because it impacts family dynamics, future societal health, and their individual health. Also, I'm sure they will find it quite intriguing as well!

How will you customize your presentation to the knowledge and interests of your audience?

Since my audience consists of non-experts from various majors, I will customize the speech by translating complex neuroscience terms into relatable analogies. For example, I will explain neural degradation as a "short circuit" in a computer's wiring. Additionally, I will emphasize the "solution" aspect—specifically how AI usage and lifestyle choices today affect their own long-term brain health—to ensure the topic feels personally relevant to 18-22-year-olds.

Body.

What organizational pattern will you use in the body?

I will use a Topical organizational pattern.

How is that organizational pattern a good fit for your type of informative speech? (Refer to examples in Chapter 15)

A topical pattern is the best fit for a "concept" speech because it allows me to divide the broad subject of neurodegenerative diseases into three distinct, logical categories: definition, causes of the rise, and preventative solutions. This structure ensures the information is delivered in a clear and organized manner for a non-expert audience.

State in full sentences the main points to be developed in the body of your speech.

1. Neurodegenerative diseases are characterized by the progressive loss of structure or function of neurons, which leads to significant cognitive and physical decline.
2. The prevalence of these diseases is escalating due to an aging global population and modern lifestyle factors, including the impact of high-frequency AI and digital tool dependency on cognitive load.
3. Individuals can take proactive steps toward prevention by maintaining "cognitive reserve" through specific lifestyle changes and mindful technology habits.

Can you answer yes to all the questions on the Main Points Checklist found in your textbook?

Yes

What steps have you taken to adapt the content of your speech so it will be clear and interesting to your audience? Be specific.

To ensure it's interesting, I'll intentionally include analogies, like comparing the biological concept of "misfolding of proteins" to a factory assembly line creating broken parts that clog the machinery. To ensure my points are coming across clearly, I'll use visual support, like diagrams of the neural pathways and photos that emphasize just how quickly this neurodegeneration happens.

Introduction.

What method(s) of gaining attention do you use in the introduction?

I will use a startling statistic regarding the projected rise of dementia cases by 2050 and a rhetorical question asking the audience if they have ever considered how their current digital habits might shape their brain's health 40 years from now.

How do you establish your credibility in the introduction?

I will establish credibility by mentioning my background as a neuroscience major and referencing the specific coursework where I have studied the physiological mechanisms of these diseases.

How do you establish relevance to your audience in the introduction?

I will explain that while these diseases are often associated with the elderly, the foundations for prevention and the societal economic burden are issues that will directly impact our generation as future professionals and caregivers.

Write the preview statement you will use in your introduction.

Today, we will examine the nature of neurodegenerative diseases, explore the environmental and technological factors driving their rise, and identify specific lifestyle habits we can adopt now to protect our long-term cognitive health.

Can you answer yes to all the questions on the Speech Introduction Checklist found in your textbook (p. 177)?

Yes

Conclusion.

What method(s) of reinforcing your central idea do you use in the conclusion?

I will use a summary of the main points to remind the audience of the connection between the rise of the disease and our daily habits, reinforcing the "concept" that prevention is a proactive journey.

How do you end your speech on an engaging/memorable closing statement?

I will end with a visionary statement: "While we cannot yet fully stop the clock on aging, the power to protect the 'human' in our brains rests in the choices we make today—starting with how we choose to engage with the world around us.

Can you answer yes to all the questions on the Speech Conclusion Checklist found in your textbook (p. 187)?

Yes